

Speaker Naming Conventions

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Overview

The requirement for creating Speaker IDs may depend on the project and if so, further instructions will be provided by the project manager for what is expected. The purpose of this document is to give general guidance on proper speaker naming conventions and should be used in tandem with any project-specific instructions provided by the project manager. The document is broken down into three main sections, the first is for 16kHz media files, the second for 8kHz split-channel files, and the third for general callouts of common mistakes.

16kHz Media Files

Using the Search Feature

Workbench allows transcribers to search for the names of celebrities and other public figures so that their demographic information can be auto-populated.

To use this feature, follow the steps below:

1. When inside a file, navigate to the “Speaker” icon on the top left-hand side.
2. In the “Speakers” pop-up box, click “Search Speakers” and begin typing the name of the public figure.
3. If the name comes up on the list, select it and the information will automatically populate below.
4. Once added, the transcriber can make changes to certain demographic information but shouldn’t have to unless something is missing.

Please note, if the name of the public figure does not appear on the list while searching, the transcriber must manually fill in their demographic information following the instructions below, and/or any instructions provided by the project manager.

Speakers

Search Speakers

|

S Marc Summers

M Terry Gross

A Joe Biden

U Kamala Harris

S Anderson Cooper

M

A

UNKNOWN

UNKNOWN

Add

vn

vn

Identifiable Speakers

If a speaker's name is identifiable (e.g., they introduce themselves, someone else calls out their name, etc.), please refer to the instructions below:

- Identify the speaker by first name, and last name if possible.
 - If the speaker's first AND last name is known, DO NOT add the file name into the Speaker Name field.
 - If only the speaker's first name is known, you must add the file name in the following format:

Speaker: John
Speaker ID: "John_filename"
 - If there are multiple speakers in a file that have the same first name and no last name, you must add a number to the naming convention to distinguish the two. You must use the following format:

Speakers: John and John
Speaker IDs: "John1_filename" and "John2_filename"
- When working on a language other than English, **do not** use accented letters in the Speaker Name field even if they are generally accepted and used in that language.
 - Accented letters should still be used in the transcription when the person's name is said.
- Fill in as much information as possible about the speaker.
 - Depending on the project, users will be asked to add varying demographic information about the speakers. This includes, but is not limited to, dialect, gender, age range, education level, etc.

Speakers

Search Speakers

Add

Speaker Name *	Dialect *	Gender *
Tanya Harrison	native	female
Age	Education	
30-50	Graduate	
Speaker Name *	Dialect *	Gender *
Matthew1_en_US_file1	native	male
Age	Education	
18-30	High School	
Speaker Name *	Dialect *	Gender *
Matthew2_en_US_file1	native	male
Age	Education	
30-50	Undergraduate	

Unidentifiable Speakers

If a speaker's name is not identified in the audio, please refer to the naming conventions below:

"Female1_filename"

"Male1_filename"

If other instructions are provided by the project manager, please follow those prior to using the naming convention above.

Please note, do not include special symbols in these labels (e.g., "Male#1_filename" or "Female-1_filename") as they will be rejected.

Speakers

Search Speakers

Add

Speaker Name *	Dialect *	Gender *
Female1_en_US_file1	native	female
Age	Education	
30-50	Graduate	
Speaker Name *	Dialect *	Gender *
Male1_en_US_file1	native	male
Age	Education	
18-30	High School	
Speaker Name *	Dialect *	Gender *
Male2_en_US_file1	native	male
Age	Education	
30-50	Undergraduate	

Multiple or No Speakers

Some segments may have multiple speakers where 3 or more people are speaking at the same time. In this case, the speaker ID should be “MultiSpeaker”, and the segment type should be marked “Babble”. In the transcription, simply enter an [other-speech] tag.

Other segments may have no speaker and simply consist of noise, static, music, laughter, etc. In this case, the segment should contain the speaker ID “NoSpeaker”, and the segment type should be marked accordingly to the noise that is present in the audio. In the transcription, simply enter the correct tag for the type of noise.

For the demographic information for these IDs, select “Unknown” for all fields. If the speakers all appear to be female or male, select the corresponding option in the Gender field.

Please note, in either case, DO NOT add any additional information to the Speaker Name field.

Speakers

Search Speakers

Add

Speaker Name *	Dialect *	Gender *
MultiSpeaker	native	unknown
Age	Education	
Unknown	Unknown	

Speaker Name *	Dialect *	Gender *
NoSpeaker	native	unknown
Age	Education	
Unknown	Unknown	

8kHz Split-Channel Files

Creating a Speaker ID

- When 8kHz files are pre-segmented, the system will automatically create a speaker ID for the file. The auto-generated speaker ID will look something like: “spk_0_f” for a female speaker or “spk_0_m” for a male speaker.
 - If the speaker’s name is not said in the audio, the speaker ID should be left as is.
 - If the speaker states their name in the audio, the speaker ID should be changed to display their name.
- In some cases, the user will see “spk_0_f” and “spk_1_f” in the same file when it has been pre-segmented. The user should listen to segments from both speakers to determine if it’s the same person or if it’s two different people.
 - If the audio is from the same speaker, the user should change the speaker IDs to match, and delete any additional speaker IDs.
 - If the audio is from two different speakers, the user should stop transcribing and report the file to the project manager immediately.
- The transcriber should also fill in as much demographic information about the speaker as possible. The required demographics will vary depending on the project type and further instructions will be provided by the project manager.

Speakers

Search Speakers

Add

Speaker Name *	Role *	Dialect *	Gender *
spk_0_f	Agent	native	female
Age	Education	Ethnicity	
18-30	Unknown	Unknown	

Non-Speech Segments

For segments that contain no speech, the segment should contain the speaker ID “NoSpeaker”, and the segment type should be marked accordingly to the noise that is present in the audio. In the transcription, simply enter the correct tag for the type of noise.

Speakers

Search Speakers

Add

Speaker Name *	Role *	Dialect *	Gender *
NoSpeaker	Other	native	unknown
Age	Education	Ethnicity	
Unknown	Unknown	Unknown	

General Callouts

16kHz & 8kHz

- Speaker IDs must not contain any special characters.
 - Unacceptable characters include, but are not limited to: #, -, ^, \$, *, !, ~, ` , /, etc.
 - Only use letters of the English alphabet, numbers, spaces, and/or underscores.
- Speaker IDs must not contain any accented letters even if the audio is in a language that commonly uses them.
- If a file has many segments that contain only noise, the file should be reported to the project manager immediately.
- If a file is primarily in a language that is not the target language, the user should stop transcribing and report the file to the project manager immediately.
- If a file has many segments where the audio quality is too poor to understand what the speaker is saying, the file should be reported to the project manager immediately.
- If the file has many segments where the audio volume is too low to understand what the speaker is saying, the file should be reported to the project manager immediately.

- For segments containing only music, the speaker label must be “NoSpeaker” with a segment type of “Music” and the proper [music] tag. DO NOT create a separate speaker ID for “Music”.
- For Speaker ID “NoSpeaker”, DO NOT add the file name in the Speaker Name field.

16kHz Only

- For identifiable speakers, their first and last name should be in the Speaker Name field when creating a new speaker ID. If only the speaker’s first name is known, the speaker ID should contain their first name and the file name. For information on how to do this, please see: [Identifiable Speakers](#).
- In cases where two speakers have the same first name, and no last name, a number should be added to differentiate the two. For information on how to do this, please see: [Identifiable Speakers](#).
- For “MultiSpeaker” speaker IDs, DO NOT include the file name in the Speaker Name field.

8kHz Only

- 8kHz files should **only have 1 speaker**.
 - If there are few segments that contain some audio from a secondary speaker, use [other-speech] tags when secondary speech is present. DO NOT transcribe secondary speech.
 - If many segments contain speech from multiple speakers, the user should stop transcribing and report the file to the project manager immediately.